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19 The pedestal was returned to the lathe so the remaining material could be cleared from the mortises to accept each foot

20 The shoulders of the tenons were undercut to fit snugly against the curved surface of the pedestal. I used a 25mm-wide chisel to keep the shoulders as straight as possible. Note the use of leather padding to protect each foot as I used an engineer's vice that has knurled steel jaws, which would otherwise have left indentations on the wood

The shoulders of the tenons were undercut to fit snugly against the curved surface of the pedestal

21 A finish was applied to all components prior to assembly. I like to use a wipe-on wipe-off polyurethane finish; however, my friend's eventual reaction indicated he may have preferred a thick full gloss finish

22 With the pedestal mounted between centres, each foot was glued into place using two-part epoxy resin. I glued them one at a time to ensure a neat fit, allowing gravity to hold them securely in place as the glue cured, rather than complicating the process with clamps placed at all sorts of odd angles

23 With all the feet glued, only the top needed to be fitted to complete the job

24 Throughout this project the original maker's style was at the forefront of my mind so I didn't want to overpower it with my own taste, just enhance what was already there. It's a difficult balance to achieve, but fortunately my friend was happy with the finished product. I too was pleased with it, so it could be called a win-win situation ●

HANDY HINTS

6. Choose adhesives according to need. To glue the top of this table I used a thick PVA glue, but for the legs I opted for epoxy resin because of its clarity and gap filling properties

7. Finishes are a personal choice. I like a wipe-on wipe-off polyurethane finish that allows the wood to stand out. Some prefer a high gloss finish, while others prefer a French polish, it really comes down to how much time you're willing to invest into the finishing process... and the look you're after

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